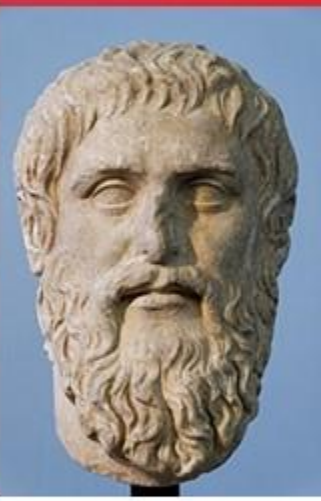
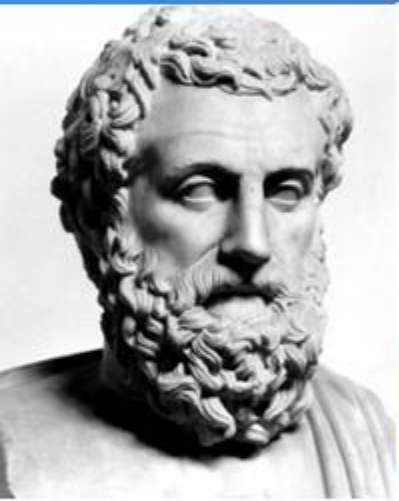


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE – 30

**ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS**

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

Ethics in International Relations refers to the **guide to good and bad** in a nation's **interaction** with other nations in **strategic, social, economic, political and other spheres**.

TEST FOR ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

There are three principal determinants of good and bad in IR.

1

NATIONAL INTEREST

2

INTERESTS OF
HUMANITY

3

SOVEREIGNTY



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

NATIONAL INTEREST

1

- **National Interest** refers to the advantage or benefit for the nation.
- Thus every **interaction of a nation with other nations** is essentially to device benefits to that nation.
- Thus, every nation argues that all her interaction with outside world that
 - Seek to bring benefits or
 - Prevent harm to her
 - ✓ People
 - ✓ Assets; and
 - ✓ Principles are ethical.



We have no eternal allies, and we have no perpetual enemies. Our interests are eternal and perpetual, and those interests it is our duty to follow.

(Henry John Temple Palmerston)

NATIONAL INTEREST

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

NATIONAL INTEREST

2 Suppose a particular river courses across two countries.

a The lower riparian country is dependent on this river for drinking water and growing food crops for self-sustenance.

b Then, if the upper riparian nation builds a dam to divert the water flow. Then the lower riparian nation may declare war.

c Then, all the destruction inflicted on the upper riparian nation is ethical to safeguard the interests of lower riparian nation.

d However, it is to be noted that the destruction inflicted is to be the barest minimum and is to be resorted to only after all other options are exhausted.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

INTERESTS OF HUMANITY

- 1 Interest of Humanity refers to the legitimate interest of all the human beings on this earth.
- 2 Many times, action of one nation shall have impact on the people across the globe.
- 3 In this regard, any action that harms the interests of humanity is regarded unethical.

Suppose a nation has conducted an atomic test in its territory. But, the radiations have spread to the neighbouring countries as well. In this case, this action cannot be called ethical.



human
interest

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

SOVEREIGNTY

- 1 Every nation possesses external sovereignty to be free from any external interference in the administration of its territory.
- 2 Thus, action of any nation that disrupts the legitimate rights of a country to govern its people and territory is regarded to be grossly unethical.



Suppose a country needs access to the crude oil in another country to run her manufacturing industry.

- a The latter country has now denied access to this crude oil to former country. This has caused a lot of concern in the former country.
- b In an attempt to save her people, the former country bribes the military of another country to displace a democratic regime. This action is grossly unethical.

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

SOVEREIGNTY

Thus, any interaction in International Relations would become ethical if it satisfies all the three following criteria:

- a Promotion of national interest; and
- b Non-harming of interest of any section of humanity; and
- c Non-interference in the sovereignty of other nations.

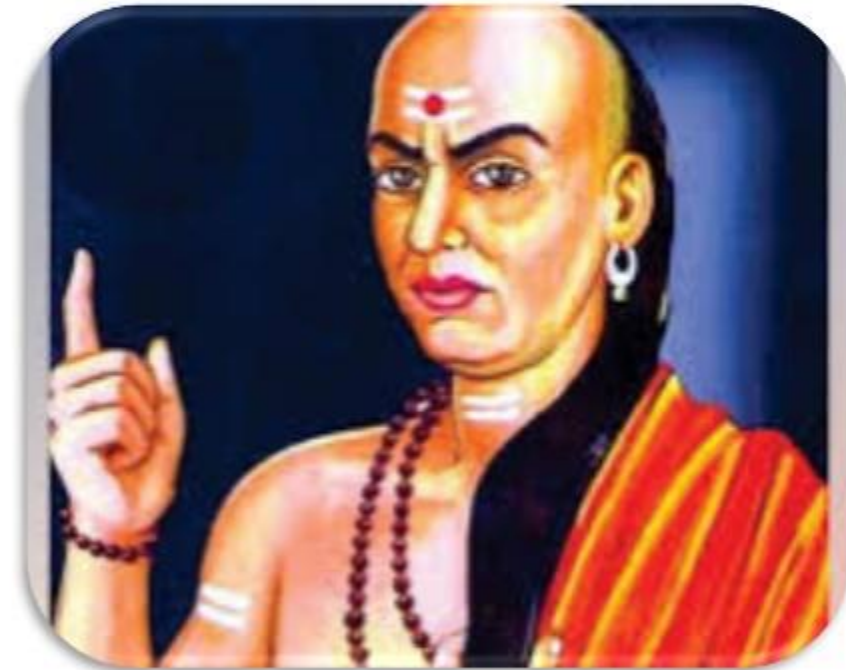
- Many times, these three criteria are not **mutually exclusive**.
- Promotion of one criterion disturbs the other criteria. Hence, it gives rise to lot of **ethical dilemmas**.
- These dilemmas have to be resolved by striking a fine balance among these criteria.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

KAUTILYA: PRAGMATIC
PHILOSOPHER

- 1 International Relations should always be **guided by self-interests**. There are neither permanent friends nor permanent enemies. There are only permanent interests.
- 2 He believed that it is primary responsibility of King to protect the interests of nation and also of the people.
- 3 Example: China vs US; India vs China.



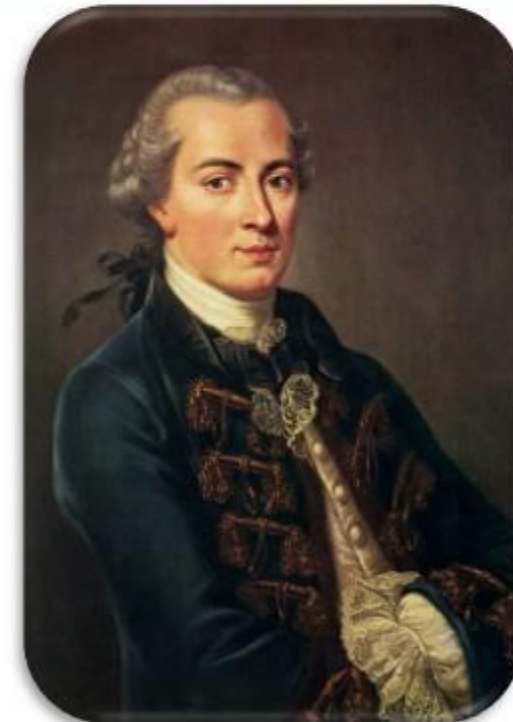
ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMMANUEL KANT:
OPPOSED TO KAUTILYA

- 1
 - Advocated cosmopolitanism. Cosmos means Universe.
 - He believed that whole universe belongs to every person. Every person on this Earth has the right to utilise the resources of the Earth. There should not be any restrictions.

- 2 Countries are nothing but artificial boundaries created by people.

- 3 This is similar to India's philosophy of "Vasudaika Kutumbakam" which believes that, the entire population on this Earth is part of single family.



PROBLEMS IN ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

- [illegible]

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

PROBLEMS IN ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

4 IMF is always headed by European countries whereas America has monopoly over World Bank.

5 1980s was considered lost decade for countries in sub-Saharan Africa and Latin America, mostly because of exploitative nature of functioning of these multilateral institutions, raising serious questions about ethics in IR and Funding.

6 In 1992, World Bank had come up with a concept called 'Good Governance' as part of aid and loan conditionality. It was nothing but continuation of Washington Consensus of 1980s.

7 2008 stock market collapse in America has resulted in global recession. PIIGS (Portugal, Ireland, Italy, Greece, Spain) Countries in Europe faced worst financial crisis.



THE WORLD BANK

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

PROBLEMS IN ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

- 8 They were forced to depend on IMF for their survival. IMF had come up with conditionality to provide financial assistance, rising questions about ethics in IR and funding.
- 9 Due to perceived failure of Globalization, USA and other European countries had opted for protectionist measures in recent times.
- 10 These measures might be good in short term from perspective of individual nations whereas they can have long term adverse consequences from the point of view of the globe.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

PROBLEMS IN ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

11 Refugee crisis in recent time had again raised questions about ethics in IR. Developed countries are not willing to accept refugees from the developing world. They are imposing severe restrictions on movement of people especially from developing countries.

12 On the other hand, developed world demands more access to financial and physical markets in developing countries, again raising questions about ethics in IR.

13 Recent climate negotiations also showed sharp divisions within the countries. Developed world demanded equality whereas developing countries insisted on equity in International relations.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

 WAR

- 1 This could be an **explicit physical war** or **implicit cold war** or **cyber war**.
- 2 War refers to the **fight between two countries** either to **protect one's interests** or **destroy another's interests**.
- 3 War involves **destroying the lives** and **assets of the opponent**



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

a

WAR

- 1 To protect one's sovereignty
- 2 To protect one's resources that genuinely belongs to the given country.
- 3 To prevent any activity in other country that is likely to snowball into a crisis in the given country. (India liberated Bangladesh in India-Pakistan War, 1971 because oppression of West Pakistan on her eastern citizens was leading to influx of refugees into India engendering a humanitarian crisis on India)

War is unethical if it is

- To appropriate the resources that genuinely belong to another country.
- To interfere in the internal affairs of another country.
- To undermine the sovereignty of another country.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

a

WAR

1

Firstly, powerful countries tend to garb their selfish interests behind war with more genuine look alike interests like protection of democracy, protection of minorities in other countries, protection of mankind from the alleged activity of hostile country and so on. Such attempts are altogether unethical.

- However, such a simplistic framework does not account for nitty-gritty.
- It always leaves scope for subjective interpretation of genuineness of interests.

2

- Secondly, war necessarily involves loss of lives of common people.
- It destroys livelihood of so many people directly and indirectly. This cannot be prevented.
- Thus war always becomes unethical. Because it is synonymous with causing pain.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

a

WAR

Thus, following attempts could ensure that war is ethical.

- 1 No attack on civilians
- 2 Non-destruction of lifelines of civilians like water bodies and water supply infrastructure, agricultural fields, hospitals and schools.
- 3 Usage of as minimum force as possible
- 4 War to be resorted to only as a last option, when all other options are exhausted.

- 5 Maintenance of armed forces and other strategic assets for defensive purposes rather than for offensive purposes.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

b

INTERNATIONAL FUNDING

- 1 This is regarding funding projects in a given country either by other countries or international bodies or even MNCs.
- 2 Firstly, funding agency is concerned with ensuring that it gets back its funding with decent returns.
- 3 In the process, it may attach a few conditions that may compromise the sovereignty of the country where it is funded.
- 4 Secondly, funding agency may choose the projects that favour and promote its interests. While national priorities may be diametrically opposite.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

b

INTERNATIONAL FUNDING

- 5** Third dimension is funding in another country to disturb peace and tranquillity in that country. Pakistan's alleged funding of terrorist and separatist activities in Kashmir.
- 6** Fourth dimension of funding is funding activities in another country to deter or destroy an altogether another third country. For example, US funding of infrastructure projects in Israel to help Israel against Palestine.
- 7** Finally, Funding in other countries as a gesture of soft power is another dimension. Here, the objective is to build cordial relationship with the other country.
- 8** However, the investments should not be used to morally bind the other country to accept the terms of the funding country.

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

b

INTERNATIONAL FUNDING

Here, the following ethical tenets have to be observed:

- 1** Funding should not have any strings that compromise a country's sovereignty.
- 2** Home country must be consulted before making funding decisions.
- 3** The funding should not be used as a bargaining chip to extract favours from the country of investment.



sovereignty

ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

C

INTERNATIONAL INVESTMENTS

International Investments refers to the deployment of capital (in expectation of return) in another country by,

- An MNC
- A Foreign Government
- International Funding is mostly for social purposes. But, International Investments is mostly for business purposes.



ETHICS IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND FUNDING

IMPORTANT IR INTERACTIONS AND THEIR ETHICALITY

C

INTERNATIONAL INVESTMENTS

Following types of ethical questions could arise with regard to International Investments:

- 1 Whether such an investment is unreasonably exploiting the natural resources.
- 2 Whether such an investment is benefitting investing-country at cost of invested-country (Just as British investments in India benefitted former at the cost of latter)

3

Whether the investment is hurting the genuine sentiments of tribal or any other social group (Just as Vedanta's investment in Niyamgiri hills adversely affected the sentiments of Dongria Kond tribe there)

4

Whether the investing party is paying up taxes regularly.

Those investments that are contributing to the welfare of both the nation and the local communities shall be considered ethical



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